1. Purpose

To establish Imperial Kitchen Group's commitment to serving authentic, safe, and accurately described food and beverages. This policy protects our guests, our brand reputation, and public health by preventing Food Fraud (Economically Motivated Adulteration) and ensuring strict truth to menu practices.

2. Scope

It encompasses every operational layer of Imperial Kitchen Group Inc., beginning with the strategic purchasing and sourcing of all ingredients, beverages, and consumables to ensure supply chain integrity from the outset. It extends deeply into back-of-house (BOH) functions, including rigorous receiving, storage, and food preparation protocols that safeguard against ingredient substitution or tampering in alignment with PD ISO/TS 22002-2:2013. Furthermore, it governs front-of-house (FOH) activities, ensuring that menu descriptions and guest communications remain transparent and honest, effectively bridging the gap between kitchen reality and consumer expectation as mandated by RA 10611.

3. Responsibilities

3.1. Quality Assurance (QA)

Shall be primarily responsible for identifying "high-risk" ingredients that are statistically and historically targeted for economically motivated adulteration within the restaurant industry. To isolate specific ingredient categories possessing a high financial incentive for fraudulent substitution or dilution, these departments conduct formal vulnerability assessments by analyzing market trends, supply chain complexities, and historical data. This proactive identification allows them to implement targeted verification protocols, such as requiring Certificates of Analysis (COA), to focus procurement resources effectively. Furthermore, they collaborate to meticulously, manage, and maintain the mandatory Approved Supplier List to ensure all ingredients originate from transparent, verifiable partners.

3.2. Supply Chain Management (SCM)

Shall be tasked with pivoting from standard purchasing models to enhanced sourcing strategies that require stringent, multi-layered verification to mitigate fraud risks. This strategy involves establishing direct, transparent relationships with vetted producers to minimize supply chain intermediaries and reduce opportunities for adulteration. Before any high-risk item can be cleared for supply chain, the SCM must also mandate incontrovertible proof of provenance and purity, which includes securing mandatory Certificates of Authenticity, detailed traceability records, or third-party analytical testing (COAs). Additionally, they must strictly restrict procurement to the Approved Supplier List managed alongside Quality Assurance to prevent unauthorized or potentially adulterated products from entering the inventory.

3.3. Back-of-House (BOH) Employees

Shall be responsible for executing rigorous receiving, storage, and food preparation protocols to safeguard against ingredient substitution or tampering. At the point of entry, these personnel act as a primary defense by performing an exact reconciliation between the physical product—including granular checks on labels, specific brands, precise cuts of meat, and seafood species—and the purchase order. Any incoming products exhibiting physical signs of tampering, unauthorized relabeling, or unapproved substitution must be immediately rejected and returned to the supplier at the point of receipt. To perform these duties effectively, BOH employees utilize specialized training provided through a comprehensive program to master the skills required to verify incoming goods' authenticity.

3.4. Executive Leadership

Shall be the one who maintains a formal governance framework that mandates an annual review of this policy and the high-risk ingredient list, supplemented by immediate updates during major menu changes to effectively respond to shifting market vulnerabilities. They maintain a strict zero-tolerance stance regarding any breach of culinary honesty. Any intentional participation in food

fraud or deceptive menu practices will result in immediate disciplinary action to protect consumer trust and uphold required ethical and legal standards.

4. Regulatory and Standard Compliance

This policy ensures our daily restaurant operations comply with:

- **Republic Act No. 10611 (Food Safety Act of 2013)**

Protecting consumers from deceptive practices, misbranding (e.g. false menu descriptions), and food adulteration.

- **PD ISO/TS 22002-2:2013 (PRPs on Food Safety - Part 2: Catering)**

Establishing rigorous prerequisite programs for the safe receipt, storage, preparation, and serving of food in a catering/restaurant setting.

5. Definitions

Food fraud constitutes a deliberate and deceptive breach of consumer trust, characterized by the intentional substitution, addition, or misrepresentation of ingredients to secure illicit economic gain. This encompasses high-risk practices such as the surreptitious replacement of premium seafood with lower-value species, the dilution of top-shelf spirits, and the fraudulent labeling of commodity proteins as specialty items like "Wagyu" or "Organic." By prioritizing profit over provenance, these actions not only compromise the culinary integrity of the establishment but also introduce significant regulatory and safety risks, necessitating a rigorous vulnerability assessment to ensure that every menu component remains authentic from the initial procurement invoice to the guest's final plate.

The truth in menu represents a fundamental ethical and legal mandate that compels a restaurant to provide absolute transparency regarding every claim presented on its menu, ensuring that all descriptions of origin, quality grade, preparation methods, dietary status, and specific branding are 100% accurate. In accordance with the consumer protection provisions of Republic Act No. 10611, this principle functions as a critical safeguard against misbranding and deceptive trade practices, holding the establishment strictly accountable for the veracity of the culinary representations. By adhering to these standards, the restaurant eliminates the risk of misleading guests–whether through the misinterpretation of a product's provenance or the obfuscation of its true ingredients–thereby fostering a culture of professional integrity that protects both the consumer's right to informed choice and the long-term reputation of the brand.

6. Key Strategies and Responsibilities

6.1. Ingredient Vulnerability Assessment

- The Quality Assurance and Management will identify "high-risk" ingredients that are statistically and historically targeted for economically motivated adulteration within the global and local restaurant industry. By analyzing market trends, supply chain complexities, and historical data as part of a formal vulnerability assessment, aforementioned departments isolate specific categories that possess a high financial incentive for fraudulent substitution or dilution. This proactive identification allows the restaurant to implement targeted verification protocols, such as Certificate of Analyses (COA), ensuring that the establishment's procurement resources are focused on the most vulnerable points of the supply chain to maintain absolute product integrity.
- To effectively mitigate the risks associated with highly vulnerable ingredients, the restaurant's procurement protocols must pivot from standard purchasing models to enhanced sourcing strategies that mandate stringent, multi-layered verification. This proactive approach involves establishing direct, transparent relationships with vetted producers to minimize supply chain intermediaries, thereby significantly reducing the opportunities for economically motivated adulteration. Furthermore, the purchasing department will require incontrovertible proof of provenance and purity–such as mandatory Certificates of Authenticity, detailed traceability records, or third-party analytical testing (COAs)--before any high-risk item is cleared for

procurement, ensuring the uncompromised integrity of the culinary supply chain from the very first transaction.

6.2. Supplier Approval and Purchasing

- To ensure absolute control over the restaurant's supply chain and compliance, procurement is strictly limited to an Approved Supplier List meticulously vetted and managed by the Quality Assurance, Supply Chain Manager, and Management. This mandatory protocol guarantees that every ingredient originates from verifiable, transparent partners who have successfully passed rigorous quality and authenticity assessments, effectively neutralizing the risk of food fraud by preventing unauthorized, unverified, or potentially adulterated products from ever entering the inventory.
- In alignment with rigorous vigilance, personnel sourcing from high-variability environments–such as local wet markets or unvetted distributors–must conduct an immediate, on-site physical appraisal to verify the freshness, quality, and authenticity of raw materials before any transactions are finalized. This frontline inspection serves as a critical gatekeeping mechanism, ensuring that the restaurant does not inadvertently introduce adulterated or "bait and switch" ingredients into the supply chain, thereby protecting both the culinary standard of the kitchen and the safety of the consumer.

6.3. Back of the House Receiving Controls

- Any substitution necessitated by stock shortages must be executed with full transparency, strictly prohibiting the use of alternative ingredients under a false or premium descriptor. Should a lower-cost substitute be required, the restaurant is obligated to either explicitly inform the guest of the change prior to service or formally mark the item as unavailable, thereby ensuring that operational constraints never compromise the establishment's legal and ethical duty to provide an honest dining experience
- The verification of all incoming goods serves as a primary defense against economically motivated food fraud requiring an exact reconciliation between the physical product and the purchase order. This granular inspection–encompassing labels, specific brands, precise cuts of meat, and seafood species–ensures that lower-value substitutes have not been surreptitiously introduced into the supply chain. By enforcing these rigorous checks at the point of entry, the restaurant upholds the consumer protection mandates of RA 10611, ensuring that only the authentic, high-quality ingredients promised to the guest are accepted into the kitchen's inventory.
- Any incoming products exhibiting physical signs of tampering, unauthorized relabeling, or unapproved substitution must be immediately rejected and returned to the supplier at the point of receipt. This uncompromising gatekeeping protocol serves as a critical final defense against economically motivated food fraud , ensuring that only verified, authentic, and safe ingredients are integrated into the kitchen's inventory to protect both public health and the establishment's professional reputation.

6.4. Staff Training and Reporting

- To ensure a robust food defense against food fraud, a comprehensive program across all departments, equipping back of the house (BOH) employees with the specialized skills required to verify the authenticity of incoming goods and front of the house (FOH) employees with the precise product knowledge necessary for transparent guest communication. In alignment with the ethical and safety mandates, this initiative fosters a culture of collective vigilance where all employees are actively encouraged to report any irregularities in sourcing or unauthorized ingredient substitutions to management. By providing a secure, non-retaliatory environment for such disclosures, the restaurant ensures that every employee acts as a guardian of culinary integrity, maintaining the standards and trust of its patrons.

7. Review and Enforcement

Management ensures the continued relevance of these food fraud defenses through a formal governance framework that mandates an annual review of this policy and the high-risk

ingredient list, supplemented by immediate updates during major menu changes. Conducted in strict adherence to Republic Act No. 10611 and PD ISO/TS 22002-2:2013, this iterative assessment allows the restaurant to pivot in response to shifting market vulnerabilities, seasonal supply variables, and evolving fraudulent tactics. Furthermore, a zero-tolerance stance is maintained regarding any breach of culinary honesty, with intentional participation in food fraud or deceptive menu practices resulting in immediate disciplinary action. This rigorous oversight underscores a steadfast dedication to protecting consumer trust while upholding the ethical and legal standards essential to an authentic dining experience.

8. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	March 26, 2026	Marielle Louise Macabale, **QA/RND Specialist**	Originator
1	May 25,2026	Celine Joy Sanchez, **QA Specialist**	• Added Responsibilities
2	June 1, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez, **QA Specialist**	• Remove two departments on responsibilities

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